WORLD EVENTS

Tracker Plus · frequently asked questions · big quakes, tsunami messages, disasters, world news and AI news

Getting started

What do I need?
Your Tracker Plus, a Wi-Fi network (2.4 GHz; it can't join 5 GHz-only networks) and a USB power supply or computer USB port.

How do I open it?
Tap World Events (the wide tile in the middle of the Home screen). Nothing to set up.

How do I get back to the Home screen?
Tap SET (top right), then Home.

Is there a subscription or account?
No. Everything comes from free public services.

The five pages

Pick a page with the tabs along the bottom. The orange tab is the page you are on.

Quakes	Earthquakes of magnitude 7 and up in the last 30 days, newest first, with the magnitude, place and how long ago. TSUNAMI means the quake was flagged for a possible tsunami.
Tsunami	The latest message from the Pacific and from the US & Canada tsunami warning centres. Warnings show in red, advisories and watches in orange.
Disasters	Orange and red alerts for storms, eruptions, floods, droughts and other disasters around the world.
World	Top world news headlines.
AI	The latest artificial-intelligence news, newest first.

Using it

How do I see more items?
When a page has more than four, tap its orange tab again to see the next few (the top bar shows which set you are on, e.g. 1/2).

How do I read the whole story?
Tap the item. You get the full headline and a short summary - for quakes the place, depth, local time and alert level; for disasters the dates and severity; for tsunami messages the bulletin text. Scan the QR code with your phone camera to open the full story. BACK returns.

Do I have to touch it?
No. Left alone for a minute, it steps through the pages by itself, 10 seconds each.

How often does it update?
Quakes and tsunami messages every 3 minutes, the other pages every 10 minutes. SET > Update now fetches everything straight away.

Alerts

When does it alert me?
A card pops up with a sound for a new magnitude 7+ quake in the last 6 hours, a tsunami warning, advisory, watch or threat in the last 6 hours, or a new red disaster alert. Tap the card to close it.

Will the same alert keep coming back?
No. Each alert shows once, even when auto-rotate restarts the app.

How do I turn the alert sound off?
Home > Settings > Sound > Choose sounds, then tap World alerts (blue = on). Quiet hours keep it silent at night.

Data

Where does the data come from?
Quakes from the US Geological Survey (USGS), tsunami messages from tsunami.gov, disasters from GDACS (Global Disaster Alert and Coordination System), world news from BBC World, AI news from TechCrunch and MIT Technology Review. All free public services.

Troubleshooting

A page says Loading for a while.
If a download fails it tries again on its next check: 3 minutes for Quakes and Tsunami, 10 minutes for the rest. Or tap SET > Update now. Check Settings > Self-test if it keeps happening.

Why is the Quakes or Tsunami page nearly empty?
Quakes of magnitude 7 and up are rare (about one a month on average), and the tsunami centres only send messages after a big quake. A quiet page is good news.

Taps land in the wrong place.
Go Home, then Settings > Cal and press the centre of each dot. From the Wi-Fi screen you can also hold the screen for 3 seconds.

It restarted by itself or froze.
Unplug it for 10 seconds and plug it back in. If it keeps happening, contact the seller.

For information only - not an official warning service. In an emergency follow your local authorities. Not affiliated with USGS, tsunami.gov, GDACS, BBC, TechCrunch or MIT Technology Review.